Mary & Joseph / My Beloved

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 2 — MARY & JOSEPH / “MY BELOVED”

CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 1

Mary and Joseph slowly move toward one another. Joseph still carries the TOOL SATCHEL.

MARY
You’re still wearing it.

JOSEPH
Of course I’m still wearing it.

MARY
You haven’t even put any tools in it yet.

JOSEPH
I don’t want to ruin it.

MARY
Joseph, it’s a tool satchel.

JOSEPH
A very nice tool satchel.

MARY
It’s supposed to get dirty.

JOSEPH
Eventually.

MARY
You’re impossible.

JOSEPH
And yet you made me a satchel.

Mary smiles.

MARY
I’m beginning to reconsider that decision.

JOSEPH
Too late.

He adjusts it proudly.

JOSEPH
It’s mine now.

MARY
You seem very pleased with yourself.

JOSEPH
I am.

MARY
Because of the satchel?

JOSEPH
Because you made the satchel.

That lands. Mary tries not to show how much she likes the answer.

MARY
That was almost charming.

JOSEPH
Almost?

MARY
Don’t ruin it.

They laugh.

THE FUTURE BECOMES SPECIFIC

Joseph moves to a small, unfinished tabletop/workpiece left from the marketplace and checks it automatically.

MARY
You’re working again.

JOSEPH
I’m looking.

MARY
At work.

JOSEPH
That’s different.

MARY
Is it?

JOSEPH
Completely.

MARY
What is it?

JOSEPH
It’s not finished.

MARY
I gathered that.

JOSEPH
It’s for us.

MARY
For us?

JOSEPH
The table.

MARY
The table?

JOSEPH
For the house.

MARY
You already started it?

JOSEPH
Of course I started it.

MARY
We’re not married yet.

JOSEPH
That’s why I’m starting now.

Mary laughs.

MARY
How big is this table?

JOSEPH
It can hold six.

MARY
Six what?

JOSEPH
People.

MARY
Six?

Joseph studies it.

JOSEPH
Maybe eight.

MARY
Eight?

JOSEPH
Eight gives us room.

MARY
For whom?

JOSEPH
Family. Friends. People passing through. Children.

MARY
Children?

JOSEPH
Eventually.

MARY
How did we go from six chairs to children this quickly?

JOSEPH
I like to plan ahead.

MARY
Clearly.

THE HOUSE THAT DOESN’T EXIST

Joseph begins seeing the home in his imagination. The stage may quietly begin to agree with them through lighting and restrained atmospheric LED content. Do not show a literal house.

JOSEPH
The table goes near the window.

MARY
We have a window?

JOSEPH
We will.

MARY
Good. I wanted one.

JOSEPH
I know.

MARY
How?

JOSEPH
You told me.

MARY
When?

JOSEPH
Twice.

Beat.

JOSEPH
Three times.

MARY
I wanted to make sure you remembered.

JOSEPH
I remember everything you tell me.

MARY
That’s a dangerous promise.

JOSEPH
I didn’t say I always agree.

Mary laughs.

A warm rectangular suggestion of window light may emerge. LED content, if used, remains abstract: warmth, architectural shadow, faint environmental texture.

MARY
If you’re putting the table by the window, I want something growing outside it.

JOSEPH
Something?

MARY
A garden.

JOSEPH
How large?

MARY
Don’t plan my garden.

JOSEPH
I’m asking.

MARY
You’re measuring it with your eyes.

Joseph realizes she is right and stops.

JOSEPH
Sorry.

MARY
Small.

She considers.

MARY
Maybe not that small.

JOSEPH
Then I’ll build a fence.

MARY
For my imaginary garden?

JOSEPH
For the goats that will eat your imaginary garden.

MARY
There are no goats in my imaginary garden.

JOSEPH
That’s because I built the fence.

Mary laughs. The imagined home is becoming emotionally tangible without becoming literal.

THE EMOTIONAL SHIFT

The comedy settles. They look at the unfinished table.

MARY
You really see it, don’t you?

JOSEPH
What?

MARY
All of it. The house. The table. The garden. Us.

JOSEPH
Don’t you?

MARY
I do.

Beat.

MARY
I just… sometimes I wonder if life ever really goes the way people plan it.

JOSEPH
What brought that on?

MARY
Nothing.

A small shrug.

MARY
Look at Nazareth. Everyone thinks they know what comes next. Grow up. Marry. Build a home. Raise a family. Grow old.

JOSEPH
Sounds terrible.

MARY
Joseph.

JOSEPH
I’m listening.

MARY
What if something changes?

JOSEPH
Then something changes.

MARY
That’s your answer?

JOSEPH
No.

Beat.

JOSEPH
Then we make another plan.

MARY
And if that one doesn’t work?

JOSEPH
Another one.

MARY
Joseph.

JOSEPH
What?

MARY
You really believe there’s a plan for everything.

Joseph considers it.

JOSEPH
For everything important.

MARY
That’s a lot of confidence.

JOSEPH
I’m building an eight-chair table for a house that doesn’t exist yet.

Beat.

JOSEPH
Confidence is required.

Mary smiles, but the question remains.

MARY
What if something happens that you can’t plan for?

Joseph looks at her. He does not yet have the mature answer he will earn later.

JOSEPH
Then I’ll figure it out.

Mary studies him.

MARY
You make it sound very simple.

JOSEPH
Maybe it is.

MARY
Maybe.

Beat.

MARY
God has always been faithful.

JOSEPH
He has.

MARY
So I suppose whatever comes… We’ll find our way through it.

Joseph looks at her. This thought opens the door into the song.

JOSEPH
Whatever comes… I’ll walk with you.

MARY
Whatever comes?

JOSEPH
Whatever comes.

JOSEPH
I should go.

MARY
Probably.

He does not move.

MARY
Joseph.

JOSEPH
I’m going.

MARY
You’re still here.

JOSEPH
I’m going now.

Mary smiles. Joseph finally starts away, then turns back.

JOSEPH
Tomorrow?

MARY
Tomorrow.

Joseph exits.

TRANSITION INTO SCENE 3 — THE FUTURE DISAPPEARS

Mary remains alone inside the imagined future. Let her be completely happy. She may touch the unfinished table, look toward the imagined window, or simply take in the home they created.

MARY
Eight chairs.

A small laugh.

MARY
Joseph…

Then, on one precise cue, the future disappears. Do NOT crossfade it beautifully.

RUPTURE

LED atmosphere: GONE. Imagined window light: GONE. Garden/environmental texture: GONE. Nazareth ambiance: GONE. “My Beloved” harmonic warmth: GONE.

Silence.

Mary notices. Scene 3 must now introduce a visual and sonic language the production has never used before. Romantic subjective theatricality is over; genuine divine interruption is about to enter.

END SCENE 2.